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Methodology



Background

The SALB programme was launched in 2001 under the impulse of the United Nations Geographic Information Working Group ([UNGIWG](#) ) and its implementation initially led by the World Health Organization ([WHO](#) ) . In 2011, SALB was transferred to the United Nations Secretariat and jointly managed by the [Geospatial Information Section](#)  of the Office of Information and Communications Technology ([OICT](#) ) and the [Statistics Division](#)  of the Department of Economic and Social Affairs ([DESA](#) ) . These offices also are Secretariat to the United Nations Committee of Experts on Global Geospatial Information Management ([UN-GGIM](#) ) . The overall objectives, concept and methods were elaborated during the first period and further defined and standardized by the UN Secretariat.

The SALB programme is implemented in five distinct phases: Outreach to United Nations Member States; designation of focal points; data provision; data processing and standardization; and data validation and dissemination. The following sections provide more details for each of the above-mentioned steps.

Outreach to National Authorities

The referenced media source is missing and needs to be re-embedded.

Every year, an official communication on the SALB programme is sent in the form of a Note Verbale in [English](#) , [French](#)  and [Spanish](#)  to the Permanent Missions of the Member States of the United Nations in order to request that information on administrative units of

Focal point designations

The referenced media source is missing and needs to be re-embedded.

A Note Verbale, or sometimes an email, from the Permanent Mission of Member States notifies the UN Secretariat of the focal point person, usually the Director of the National Geospatial Information Authority or designated representative. The focal point is then officially assigned to liaise with the Secretariat and its contact details are made available in the Data section.

Data provision

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The UN Secretariat provides credentials to the focal point to access the country page and upload the geospatial data on administrative units through the SALB website. The geospatial data can also be provided via email, official in-person delivery or File Transfer Protocol (FTP) to the Secretariat. The Data provision terms are detailed in the [Terms for Contribution](#) .

Data processing and standardization

The referenced media source is missing and needs to be re-embedded.

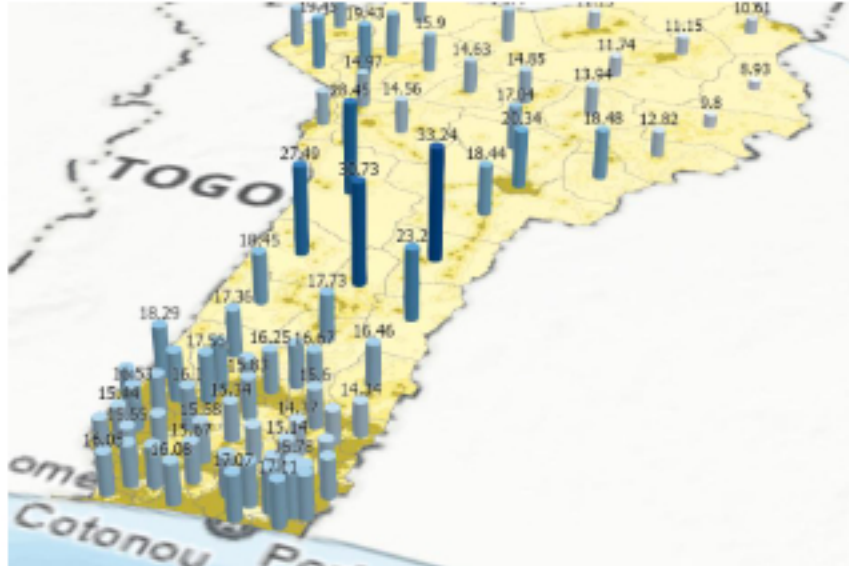
The data is then checked, when needed adjusted and harmonized following the [Data specifications](#)  and the United Nations internal policies and in order to be able to aggregate the country specific data collected into regional or global maps. The application of the Data specification is the mean for a common and global representation and ensures the homogeneity and quality of the data that is being shared.

Data validation and dissemination

The referenced media source is missing and needs to be re-embedded.

Once processed, the data is shared with the National Geospatial Information Authority for validation. Once validated by the National Geospatial Information Authority, the Data is made available publicly for download from the [Data](#)  section of the website. The use of the data are detailed in the [Terms of Use](#) , as well as in the above Data specifications.

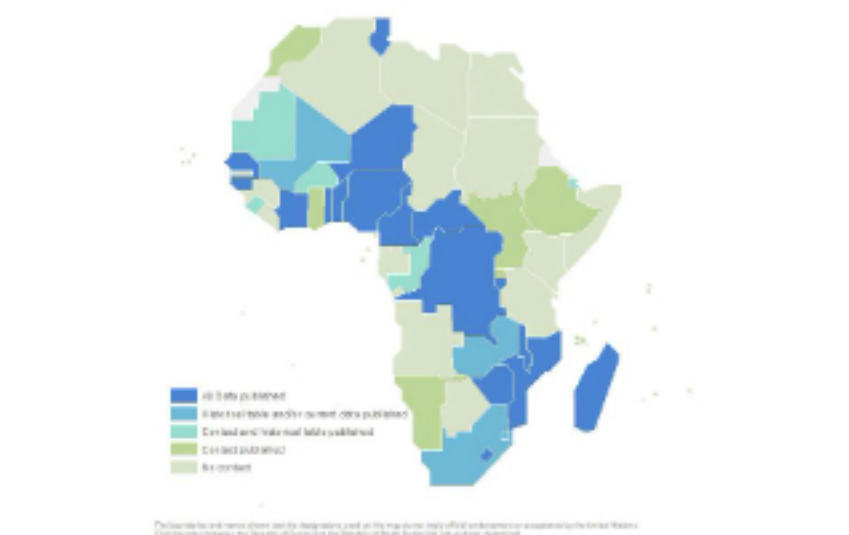
News



Improving access to education with climate analysis in Benin

01 March 2023

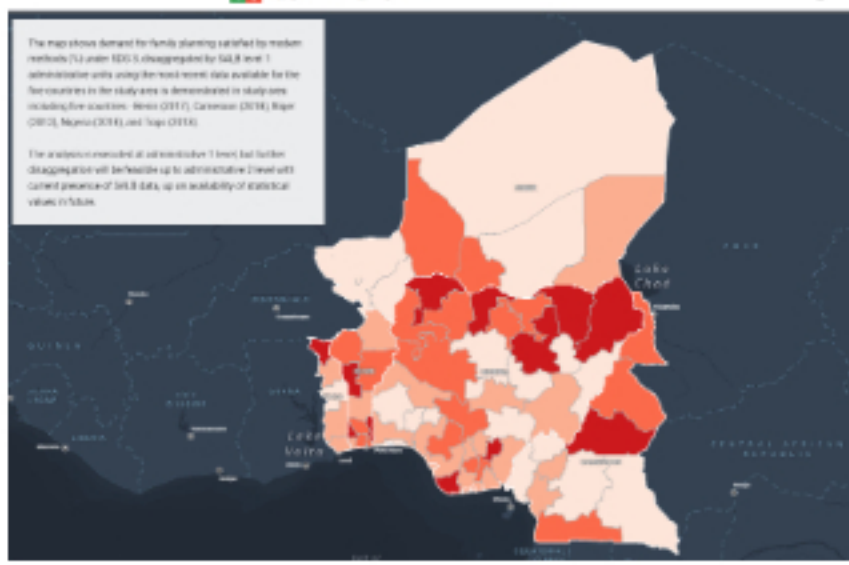
The story map below presents how geospatial data on precipitation and temperature through time and disaggregated at sub-national impact for better planning of school calendars. The story map is a collaboration with the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization ([UNESCO](#)), International Institute for Educational Planning ([IIEP](#)), the full screen version is available [her](#)



Toward a pan-African geospatial dataset on common geographies

28 February 2023

Administrative boundaries have been highlighted as a priority "core global fundamental geospatial data theme" by the Committee of Experts on Global Geospatial Information Management ([UN-GGIM](#)) Working Group on Global Fundamental Geospatial Data Themes.



Demand for family planning in Africa

26 January 2023

The story map below presents how statistics and common geographies, or administrative units, can provide a better understanding of patterns and changes to the need and demand for modern family planning methods in Central and West Africa. The story map is a collaboration with the United Nations Population Fund ([UNFPA](#)) and IPUMS, the full screen version is [here](#).

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Nationaal Geo Institu...
@NGIGN_BeGeo · Aug 1

Replying to @NGIGN_BeGeo

Enhanced coordination among all stakeholders in the field of geodesy and improved collaboration is paramount. @UNGGIM its Subcommittee on #Geodesy and #UNGGCE are the only sustainable road to long term stable funding by Member States, good knowledge transfer and capacity building



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UN-GGIM reposted



Paloma Merodio 
@PalomaMerodio · Aug 3

We welcome you to the second day of the Thirteenth Session of the United Nations Committee of Experts on Global Geospatial Information Management @UNGGIM . Watch it live on UN Web TV! Connect here [media.un.org/en/asset/k1g/k...](#) #UNGGIM13



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